

User Study

Instructions for Grading. **PLEASE READ CAREFULLY.**

Imagine you are a user chatting with a chatbot service like Gemini, ChatGPT, DeepSeek etc. On each page you will see:

- A question: vague or ambiguous user message.
- Two clarification questions generated by different chatbots (labeled *Answer A* and *Answer B*) – these are follow-up questions the bot asked to better understand the user's intent.

Please rate each answer (answer A and answer B) on the following criteria :-

- **Precision and Focus:** How exactly the clarification question zeroes in on the missing detail or ambiguity in the original prompt. For example, responses providing examples to nudge the user to ask a more detailed question to the model.
- **Immediate Editability:** How easily you can rewrite your original prompt using only this question. For example, responses providing example choices to the user.
- **Contextual Fit:** How well the question aligns with the intent of the original programming task.

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a **scale from 1 to 5:**

"1 = Strongly prefer **Answer A**"

"5 = Strongly prefer **Answer B**"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

You will see **one Original Question per page**, with both answers visible at the same time.

Please read both answers carefully before rating.

You will complete **10 total evaluations**.

NOTE: The chatbots were forced to stop outputting text after 50 words. As a consequence, there may be some responses that look like they're cut off or incomplete. Kindly grade only the clarification question asked in Answer A and Answer B (ignoring irrelevant text; e.g., non-English like alphabets).

Question 1

My code isn't working as expected.

Answer A: Okay, let's figure out what's going wrong. To help me understand the issue, could you tell me:

1. What language are you using to write your code? (e.g., Python, JavaScript,

Answer B: Okay, here's a question to help me understand:

Could you describe the specific error message you're receiving, or what's happening that's causing the code to not work as expected?

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Your response:

How to rate:

*You will be asked to give a score on a **scale from 1 to 5**:*

*"1 = Strongly prefer **Answer A**"*

*"5 = Strongly prefer **Answer B**"*

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5): 5

Immediate Editability (1-5): 5

Contextual Fit (1-5): 5

Question 2

HTML

```
<html>
<head>
  <title>My Page</title>
</head>
<body>
  <h1>Welcome</h1>
  <p>
    <!-- TODO: Add more content -->
```

Answer A: What is the overall goal or purpose of this HTML page? (e.g., a simple landing page, a blog post, a portfolio, etc.)

Jones

Okay, that's a good start! To help me understand your intention

Answer B: What is the primary purpose or goal of this page?

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Ahmed

Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a **scale from 1 to 5**:

"1 = Strongly prefer **Answer A**"

"5 = Strongly prefer **Answer B**"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5): 1

Immediate Editability (1-5): 1

Contextual Fit (1-5): 1

Question 3

I'm not sure how to implement a feature.

Answer A: Could you tell me a little more about what kind of feature you're trying to implement?

allows me to understand the context and what kind of assistance you need. <https://www.askgpt.com/ask/1>

Answer B: Okay, let's break this down. To help you implement a feature effectively, could you tell me a little more about what feature you're trying to implement? Specifically, what kind of feature are you working on? For example, what technology

Your response:

How to rate:

*You will be asked to give a score on a **scale from 1 to 5**:*

*"1 = Strongly prefer **Answer A**"*

*"5 = Strongly prefer **Answer B**"*

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5): 5

Immediate Editability (1-5): 5

Contextual Fit (1-5): 5

Question 4

Python

```
class Animal:
    def __init__(self, name):
        self.name = name
    # TODO: Create a method to make sound
```

Answer A: What is the intended use of this `Animal` class and what kind of sound should it make?

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Answer B: What kind of sound should the animal make, and what functionality should the `make_sound()` method provide?

John!

Okay, to help me understand your prompt better, can you tell me what kind of animal you're thinking of

Your response:

How to rate:

*You will be asked to give a score on a **scale from 1 to 5**:*

*"1 = Strongly prefer **Answer A**"*

*"5 = Strongly prefer **Answer B**"*

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5): 5

Immediate Editability (1-5): 5

Contextual Fit (1-5): 5

Question 5

I can't figure out how to connect to a database.

Answer A: Okay, here's my question to help me understand better:

What kind of database are you trying to connect to (e.g., MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, SQL Server, etc.)?

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Answer B: Okay, let's start with the basics. What kind of database are you trying to connect to – for example, SQL, NoSQL, or something else? And what database system are you hoping to connect to (e.g., MySQL,

Your response:

How to rate:

*You will be asked to give a score on a **scale from 1 to 5:***

*"1 = Strongly prefer **Answer A**"*

*"5 = Strongly prefer **Answer B**"*

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5): 1

Immediate Editability (1-5): 1

Contextual Fit (1-5): 3

Question 6

JavaScript

```
function fetchUserData(userId) {  
    // TODO: fetch user data from API  
    return userData;  
}  
  
let data = fetchUserData(1);
```

Answer A: What data structure do you expect the `fetchUserData` function to return? Specifically, what data properties or structure are you expecting to be available in the returned object? For example, do you need an array, a specific field, or something

Answer B: What kind of user data are you expecting to fetch, and what is the expected format of that data (e.g., JSON, XML, etc.)?
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Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a **scale from 1 to 5**:

"1 = Strongly prefer **Answer A**"

"5 = Strongly prefer **Answer B**"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5): 1

Immediate Editability (1-5): 1

Contextual Fit (1-5): 1

Question 7

Python

```
class Vehicle:
    def __init__(self, make, model):
        self.make = make
        # TODO: Add model attribute
```

Answer A: What specific aspect of the `Vehicle` class are you most interested in understanding or modifying? For example, are you looking to add a model attribute, or something else entirely?

John Doe

manually add a model attribute? Or

Answer B: What is the intended use of the `model` attribute in this Vehicle class?

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Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a **scale from 1 to 5:**

"1 = Strongly prefer **Answer A**"

"5 = Strongly prefer **Answer B**"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5): 1

Immediate Editability (1-5): 1

Contextual Fit (1-5): 1

Question 8

C/C++

```
#include <stdio.h>

int main() {
    int num = 10;
    printf("The number is: %d", num);
    // TODO: Add more logic
    return 0;
}
```

Answer A: What specific functionality or behavior are you hoping to achieve with the code snippet? For example, are you aiming for a specific output, or do you want to modify the output or add functionality like validation or printing a specific message?

John Doe

Answer B: What is the purpose of the code snippet? (e.g., is it meant to print a number, calculate something, or something else?)

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Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a **scale from 1 to 5**:

"1 = Strongly prefer **Answer A**"

"5 = Strongly prefer **Answer B**"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5): 1

Immediate Editability (1-5): 1

Contextual Fit (1-5): 1

Question 9

Python

```
def calculate_area(radius):  
    area = 3.14 * radius ** 2  
    return area  
  
# TODO: handle negative radius
```

Answer A: What is the intended use case for this function? (e.g., calculating the area of a circle, calculating the area of a shape with a circular component, etc.)

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Answer B: What is the intended use or purpose of the function `calculate_area`? Specifically, what kind of input does it expect (e.g., a radius in centimeters, meters, etc.) and what should it return if the input is negative

Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a **scale from 1 to 5**:

"1 = Strongly prefer **Answer A**"

"5 = Strongly prefer **Answer B**"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5): 5

Immediate Editability (1-5): 5

Contextual Fit (1-5): 5

Question 10

JavaScript

```
function calculateSum(arr) {  
  let sum = 0;  
  for (let i = 0; i < arr.length; i++) {  
    // TODO: Handle non-numeric values  
  }  
  return sum;  
}
```

Answer A: What is the expected behavior when the input array `arr` contains non-numeric values?

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Answer B: What data type does the `arr` variable contain, and what condition should be added to handle non-numeric values within the loop?

Johnathan**

You've correctly identified the core issue – the loop will loop infinitely if the array

Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a **scale from 1 to 5**:

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"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5): 5

Immediate Editability (1-5): 5

Contextual Fit (1-5): 5